

Table 1: Family Finder — British Vascular Plants *Flowers not green or brown · radially or bilaterally symmetric · herbaceous plants*

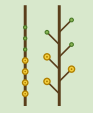
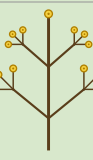
Flower arrangement	 3 or 6 petals (or multiples)	 4 petals	 5 petals joined (tubular / bell)	 5 petals free	 7+ petals	 Bilateral flowers			
 Single or pair	Amaryllidaceae Iridaceae Liliaceae Colchicaceae Aristolochiaceae Hydrocharitaceae Alismataceae	Papaveraceae Rosaceae Onagraceae Caryophyllaceae Gentianaceae	Primulaceae Ericaceae Convolvulaceae Campanulaceae Apocynaceae	Gentianaceae Solanaceae Caprifoliaceae Menyanthaceae	Ranunculaceae Rosaceae Geraniaceae Caryophyllaceae Hypericaceae Oxalidaceae Saxifragaceae Parnassiaceae	Malvaceae Paeoniaceae Linaceae Cistaceae Portulacaceae Montiaceae Limnanthaceae Sarraceniaceae	Ranunculaceae Nymphaeaceae Primulaceae Rosaceae Gentianaceae	Paeoniaceae Aizoaceae (Asteraceae - check!) (Caryophyllaceae - check!)	Fabaceae Violaceae Balsaminaceae Caprifoliaceae Lentibulariaceae Ranunculaceae Orchidaceae
 In Leaf Axils	Liliaceae Lythraceae Aristolochiaceae	Onagraceae Rosaceae Rubiaceae Caryophyllaceae (Veronicaceae - <i>Veronica</i> ; bilateral)	Boraginaceae Ericaceae Primulaceae Campanulaceae Convolvulaceae	Apocynaceae Solanaceae Curcubitaceae Hydrophyllaceae	Malvaceae Hypericaceae Caryophyllaceae Polygonaceae Crassulaceae Rosaceae Primulaceae Lythraceae	Portulacaceae Linaceae Cistaceae Oxalidaceae Saxifragaceae (Solanaceae - <i>Solanum</i> ?) Santalaceae Frankeniaceae	Aizoaceae (Caryophyllaceae - check!) (Onagraceae - check!)	Lamiaceae Veronicaceae Caprifoliaceae Fabaceae Onagraceae Violaceae	Balsaminaceae Phrymaceae Scrophulariaceae Orobanchaceae Tropaolaceae - Tropaeolum
 Spike or Raceme	Liliaceae Lythraceae Dioscoreaceae Alismataceae Asparagaceae Amaryllidaceae Nartheciaceae	Resedaceae Polygonaceae Iridaceae Scheuchzeriaceae Asphodelaceae Tofieldiaceae Pontederiaceae (semi-aquatic)	Brassicaceae Onagraceae Resedaceae Polygonaceae	Campanulaceae Boraginaceae Ericaceae Menyanthaceae Crassulaceae Primulaceae Curcubitaceae Resedaceae	Rosaceae Lythraceae Resedaceae Polygonaceae Saxifragaceae Droseraceae	Linaceae Cistaceae Portulacaceae Ranunculaceae Santalaceae Phytolaccaceae	(Brassicaceae - <i>Draba</i> ? Check!) (Onagraceae - <i>Epilobium</i> ? Check!) Resedaceae	Lamiaceae Veronicaceae Scrophulariaceae Papaveraceae (Fumarioideae) Fabaceae Onagraceae (<i>Chamaenerion</i>) Orchidaceae Polygalaceae Balsaminaceae	Verbenaceae Brassicaceae (<i>Iberis</i> , <i>Teesdalia</i>) Ranunculaceae Resedaceae Campanulaceae Iridaceae (e.g. <i>Crocsmia</i>) Lentibulariaceae Boraginaceae
 Umbel	Liliaceae Amaryllidaceae Butomaceae (Alismataceae - not true umbels)	Papaveraceae	Primulaceae Curcubitaceae	Apiaceae Hydrocotylaceae Geraniaceae Oxalidaceae Rosaceae		Apiaceae (outer florets only) Fabaceae Alstromeriaceae			
 Complex group	Dioscoreaceae Alismataceae Asparagaceae Polygonaceae Rosaceae Rubiaceae Commelinaceae	Rubiaceae (Rosaceae - <i>Alchemilla</i> ; sepals?) Brassicaceae Crassulaceae Saxifragaceae Gentianaceae Onagraceae (Veronicaceae - <i>Veronica</i>)	Boraginaceae Valerianaceae Gentianaceae Primulaceae Solanaceae Rubiaceae (<i>Rubia</i>)	Polemoniaceae Plumbaginaceae Caprifoliaceae Ericaceae Nyctaginaceae Hydrophyllaceae	Rosaceae Hypericaceae Polygonaceae Caryophyllaceae Saxifragaceae Crassulaceae	Malvaceae Ranunculaceae Geraniaceae Linaceae Montiaceae (Solanaceae)	(Asteraceae - actually a tight head) (Caryophyllaceae - bifid petals) Ranunculaceae Rosaceae Gentianaceae (<i>Blackstonia</i>)	Scrophulariaceae Valerianaceae Balsaminaceae Lamiaceae Polemoniaceae Boraginaceae Alstromeriaceae	
 Tight head	Asparagaceae Amaryllidaceae Asphodelaceae Bromeliaceae	Dipsacaceae Rosaceae Brassicaceae Eriocaulaceae Polygonaceae Rubiaceae (Asteraceae)	Asteraceae Dipsacaceae Campanulaceae (Boraginaceae) Valerianaceae Convolvulaceae	Caryophyllaceae Rosaceae Apiaceae Plumbaginaceae Cannabaceae (Asteraceae) Polygonaceae	(Asteraceae - 5 fused petals) (Caryophyllaceae - bifid petals)	Fabaceae Asteraceae (ray florets) Lamiaceae Dipsacaceae Valerianaceae Caprifoliaceae			

Table 2 · Green/Brown Flowers — herbs

Flower arrangement	Broad leaves		Grass-like leaves	
 Single / pair	(Araceae - monoecious spike) Plantaginaceae Caryophyllaceae Asparagaceae Amaryllidaceae Melanthiaceae (<i>Paris</i>) Euphorbiaceae		Caryophyllaceae	
 Leaf axils	Polygonaceae Amaranthaceae (incl. <i>Chenopodium</i>) Rosaceae Euphorbiaceae Urticaceae	Caryophyllaceae Callitrichaceae Santalaceae Rubiaceae	Caryophyllaceae Amaranthaceae	
 Spike / raceme	Plantaginaceae (<i>Plantago</i>) Polygonaceae (<i>Rumex</i>) Amaranthaceae Resedaceae Euphorbiaceae Urticaceae	Cannabaceae Curcubitaceae Potamogetonaceae Araceae Scheuchzeriaceae	Poaceae Cyperaceae Resedaceae Typhaceae Juncaginaceae	Araceae Orchidaceae Acoraceae Potamogetonaceae Polygonaceae
 Umbel	Araliaceae Curcubitaceae Apiaceae			
 Complex group	Polygonaceae Amaranthaceae Euphorbiaceae Rosaceae Urticaceae	Cannabaceae Saxifragaceae Gunneraceae Curcubitaceae Scrophulariaceae	Poaceae Cyperaceae Juncaceae Amaranthaceae Polygonaceae	
 Tight head	Plantaginaceae Euphorbiaceae Amaranthaceae Rosaceae Typhaceae	Adoxaceae Cannabaceae Asteraceae Santalaceae	Juncaceae Poaceae Cyperaceae Typhaceae	

Table 4 · Fully Aquatic Plants

Tiny flowers (<2 mm)			Conspicuous / white flowers	
<i>Leaves all at stem base</i>	<i>Leaves all along stem</i>	<i>Tiny floating plant</i>		
Zosteraceae Plantaginaceae Callitrichaceae Brassicaceae Eriocaulaceae	Callitrichaceae Potamogetonaceae Haloragaceae (whorled; finely pinnate) Hippuridaceae Hydrocharitaceae Typhaceae	Ceratophyllaceae (whorled; bifid) Elatinaceae Cyperaceae Zannichellaceae Ruppiaceae	Araceae (Lemnoideae)	Nymphaeaceae Menyanthaceae Polygonaceae Hydrocharitaceae Alismataceae Campanulaceae
				Lentibulariaceae Ranunculaceae Primulaceae (<i>Samolus</i>) Butomaceae Aponogetonaceae

Notes

- Families arranged in order of occurrence (column-wise)
- Family names follow Stace (2019).
- There may be taxonomic changes from the texts you use.
 - e.g. Liliaceae s.l. split & Scrophulariaceae s.l. split.

Key references Stace (2019) *New Flora of the British Isles*, 4th ed. · Poland & Clement (2020) *Vegetative Key to the British Flora* · Rose & O'Reilly (2006) *The Wildflower Key*

Table 3 · Trees, Shrubs, Woody Climbers · Petal counts in brackets

a. Coloured (not green/brown) flowers — broken down by colour within radial symmetry

Flower shape	 White / cream	 Yellow	 Pink / purple	 Bilateral
 Petals free	Rosaceae (5) Cornaceae (4) Aquifoliaceae (4) Hydrangaceae (4-5) Tamaricaceae (5) Passifloraceae (5; corona of many infertile stamens) Rutaceae (5; <i>Choisya</i>)	Hypericaceae (5) Cornaceae (4) Berberidaceae (many) Grossulariaceae (5; <i>Ribes odoratum</i>) Rosaceae (5; <i>Kerria</i>) Sapindaceae (4; <i>Koelreuteria</i>) Rutaceae (4-5; <i>Ruta</i>)	Onagraceae (4; <i>Fuchsia</i>) Grossulariaceae (5; <i>Ribes sanguineum</i>) Rosaceae (5; <i>Spiraea</i>) Ericaceae (3; <i>Empetrum</i>) Tamaricaceae (5) Thymeleaceae (4; <i>Daphne</i> , actually sepals) Pittosporaceae (5)	Fabaceae (5) Sapindaceae (4-5; <i>Aesculus</i>)
 Petals joined	Caprifoliaceae (5) Rhamnaceae (5) Oleaceae (4-6) Viburnaceae (5) Sambucaceae (5)	Ericaceae (4-5) Diapensiaceae (5) Myrtaceae (4-5) Simaroubaceae (5; <i>Ailanthus</i>)	Oleaceae (4-6; <i>Jasminum</i> , <i>Forsythia</i>)	Scrophulariaceae (4) Ericaceae (4-5) Solanaceae (5) Oleaceae (4-6) Garryaceae (4) Escalloniaceae (5) Rutaceae (4; <i>Correa</i>)
				Caprifoliaceae (5) Ericaceae (5) Paulowniaceae (5)

b. Green/brown flowers

 Catkins	 Flower-shaped (greenish)	Other	
Salicaceae Betulaceae Fagaceae Myricaceae Juglandaceae	Sapindaceae Malvaceae Celastraceae Rhamnaceae Thymeleaceae	Grossulariaceae Amaranthaceae Anacardiaceae (dense <i>Rhus</i>) or diffuse (<i>Cotinus</i>) Griselinaceae	Ulmaceae (small axillary clusters) Vitaceae (woody climber, leaf opposed infls) Platanaceae (globose pendant heads) Oleaceae (axillary clusters) Eleagnaceae (axillary clusters)
			Buxaceae (monoecious clusters) Moraceae (very odd fls; <i>Ficus</i> or <i>Morus</i>) Nothofagaceae Myrtaceae (<i>Eucalyptus</i>)

Table 5 · Without Chlorophyll

Mode	Families / notes
Root parasite	Orobanchaceae (<i>Orobanche</i> , <i>Lathraea</i>)
Stem parasite	Convolvulaceae (<i>Cuscuta</i>)
Mycoheterotrophic	Ericaceae (<i>Hypopitys</i>) Orchidaceae (<i>Neottia nidus-avis</i>)

Work In Progress!

- If you find mistakes, email me at max.carter-brown@aru.ac.uk